

Bella Khan (The Overwhelmed First-Year Student)



Bella Khan is a 19 year-old first year student majoring in Biology at York University. She lives in Calumet residence where it is her first time living away from home, and although she is getting used to the independence, she usually feels overwhelmed by the increased level of responsibility that comes with it. She has a busy schedule with classes and extracurriculars but still manages to contact her parents every evening, usually when reviewing her lecture slides for the next day. Bella is academically driven individual who is looking forward to pursuing medical school in the future, which makes her especially alert of her current grades as she is in her initial stages.

Bella recently has been noticing how quickly her academic expenses have been piling up. Her courses have requirements for purchases to be made, this includes a lab coat, safety goggles, and required textbooks. She feels worried since she has begun using her savings which is decreasing faster than expected. When she enrolled late in a mathematics course, she was surprised that a required textbook was costing her over \$150 at the campus bookstore. Bella hesitated before purchasing the textbook. She thought about delaying the purchase and finding a cheaper option elsewhere.

Later in the day, Bella searched online for a used edition but had no luck, she came across outdated and incorrect versions of the textbook. This made her feel more cautious about her spending since alternative options seemed more unsafe.

Bella uses her phone constantly and is experienced with tools such as Notion, Google Docs, and budgeting apps. She expects websites to be authentic and organized. When a platform feels unclear, she tends to feel anxious about it, resulting in no longer using it. Instead of just saving her finances, Bella wants certainty. She wants to know that the textbook she is buying matches her syllabus, and that the seller is trustworthy.

LionsList represents more than just an alternative to the YorkU bookstore for Bella. She wants to feel secure in knowing that the seller is also a verified YorkU student, and that the listing will help reduce her financial stress. She feels that a system like LionsList is a safety net during an already stressful academic transition.

Jimmy Kane (The Upper-Year Student)



Jimmy Patel is a 22 year-old Mathematics student at York University who is completing his final semester before graduation. His apartment bookshelf is organized with advanced textbooks from throughout his previous academic years. He tends to be very detail-oriented and studies by adding annotations and sticky notes in his textbooks when studying for exams. He treats his textbooks with care since they were carefully purchased in his second and third year. Jimmy now plans to move into a full-time position after graduation where he is determined to sell the textbooks he no longer needs.

Jimmy has had past experiences with trying to sell his textbooks online, through platforms like Kijiji and Facebook Marketplace. The experiences often left him frustrated since buyers frequently offered significantly less than the listed price, agreed to meet but changed their minds at the last minute, and had difficulty understanding if the textbook was for their course. Since Jimmy values clear communication and smooth processes, he was very disappointed and had stopped posting his items online.

Jimmy's typical weekday starts with him spending his mornings reviewing notes or working through his assignments at Scott library before attending lectures. He frequently uses programming tools and solves mathematical problems due to his coursework. In the afternoons, he works his part-time job as a teaching assistant for a course he has previously taken. He spends the majority of his time on technology, whether it's on his laptop or phone. Due to his passions and knowledge, Jimmy expects the digital platforms he uses to feel logical, smooth and reliable. If a system feels unorganized, Jimmy would lose his patience in continuing to use it.

Jimmy decides to start using LionsList since it provides him with what he is looking for, a focused academic marketplace limited to YorkU students. He feels at ease knowing that there is a structured process where courses are tied to their supplies needed. He has started to post a listing quickly, connect it with students who need the material, and complete the exchange smoothly. Jimmy has been successfully making his sales and his textbooks on the shelf have decreased. He feels that LionsList has been trustworthy and beyond efficient where selling his textbooks felt less like a hassle, and more like a knowledge transfer.